
23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

6 September 2026

"You have won back your brother"

God appoints Ezekiel a watchman, a guardian, this Sunday. When danger comes, he must speak, and, if he stays silent, the harm is on his head. That duty did not end with the prophets. It belongs to every one of us, the baptised.

But notice how Jesus asks it to be done. Not a public shaming. Not plastered across social media first. Go quietly, he says, just the two of you. Our world has forgotten this. It is quick to condemn, quick to cancel, quick to cast people out for their failures. The Gospel does the opposite: it corrects in order to win the person back. Cancel culture writes people off. Christ never does.

That is correction properly understood. Correction rooted in the one debt St Paul says we can never pay off: the debt of love. Love that does not depend on the other person deserving it. Love that speaks the truth gently, patiently, without a hint of superiority, given unconditionally and always keeps the door open.

And yes, speaking that truth today can cost us. We may be laughed at, called outdated, told to keep our faith to ourselves. But speak anyway. Kindly, humbly, but speak. Silence is not kindness; it is abandonment. So many we love have not rejected the faith, they have simply drifted, the fire has gone low. A word of love may be the very thing that rekindles it.

This week, be a gentle guardian. A phone call. A visit. *"I miss seeing you at Mass"* — said and meant. *"I'm praying for you"* — said and done.

We are never sent out alone. Christ goes with us — his love poured into our hearts. Your duty now is to go, and pour it out.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £2444.00; **Sion Mills:** £1395.00. Thank you.

Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 7 September after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Collection Counters The following are asked to count the collection for the month of September: Aoife Doherty's Team.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Rosa Maria McElroy

Mollie Eileen McIlroy

Tess Hegarty

Koby Martyn Burns

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Teresa Madden, 14 Glenview Park

Aiden (Cookie) Dunne, 6 Townsend Street

Eamon McNulty, 5 Ballyduff Park

Martin Gallagher, Bingley, formerly Laurel Drive

Evelyn Baxter, Castlederg

Anniversaries

Marie Logue, Martha Reid, Brendan Kearney

Gerard Maguire, Teresa Casey, Kathleen Christy

Rose Graham, John McHugh, Nora McLaughlin

Betty Montague, Danny McDaid, Sarah Huston-Richmond

Johnnie Montague, Mariah McElwee, Frances McElwee-Gallagher

George Patterson, Catherine Gibson, Bernadette Barclay

Margaret Blee, James Foley, Frances Duncan

Michael McDevitt, Kathleen McDevitt, Rosemary Stewart

Tommy Barr, Aiden Callen, Lena Kelly

Collection for Retired Priests The Annual Collection for Retired Priests will be taken up at all Masses next Sunday 13 September. This is a collection to help assist priests who have retired from active ministry. There is an envelope marked '*Clergy Retirement Fund*' in your box of envelopes for this collection. Anyone contributing to this collection by cheque should make it payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish.

Vocations We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Baptism Dates Melmount

September: Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for September to the Parish Office on **Monday 21 September from 2.00pm - 4.30pm**. The Draw for September will take place on Thursday 24 September at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Society of St. Juan Vianney Branch will meet on Tuesday 8 September in the Church of the Immaculate Conception. Rosary after 10.00am Mass and meeting will continue in St. Patrick's Hall, Barrack Street afterwards.

Legion of Mary will meet in the Green Room, behind St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills each Monday evening at 7.30pm. New members welcome. The Rosary for Peace will be said at the Grotto tomorrow Monday 7 September at 12 noon.

40 Hours Eucharistic Adoration, St. Mary's Church, Castlefin Begins with Mass on Friday 11/12 September at midnight continuous Eucharistic Adoration. Finishes on Sunday 13 September at 4.00pm. Prayer and Benediction on Sunday at 3.30pm. All are welcome.

Study Theology Online, is this for you? The Priory Institute provides Theology courses to degree level. Attend Saturday lectures in Tallaght or from the comfort of your own home. Register now before 19 September. For more information see prioryinstitute.com.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on Thursday 10 September at 7.30pm in the Radisson Blu Hotel, Letterkenny. This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age their child died, the circumstances of their death or how recent their death was. Advance registration not necessary. We also offer online support group meetings. To find out more call 0035385 288

8888 or email

Info@Anamcara.ie

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly *The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust* and *The Irish Pilgrimage Trust*) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's, Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St. Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNL Station to present the donation to the RNL. ***Please Note:*** *Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St. Patrick's Church, Dungiven at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.*

Rise and Shine Trust Easter 2027 Pilgrimage Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11 – 30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with the Rise and Shine Trust. *The trip is free to guests travelling with the Group.* The application form is available online at riseandshine.ie. Closing date for applications is 15 October 2026. Applications are also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests on the trip. Carers applications at riseandshine.ie. For more information visit **www.Riseandshine.ie** or contact Sian 07960211352 or Maurice 07711504821.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

. *Northern Ireland emergency services:* PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency Social Work Services* 0800 1979 995.